

THE HISTORY AND PURPOSE OF REGIONAL FORUMS

Regional Forums originated in 1975 at the suggestion of Dr. Jack Norris, then Chair of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous. They were to be weekend sharing and informational sessions designed to help the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, the Grapevine Staff, and the General Service Office Staff stay in touch with A.A. members, trusted servants and newcomers to service throughout the A.A. service structure.

Originally, at the invitation of a region, four Regional Forums were held each year. Since the U.S./Canada service structure is composed of eight regions, a Regional Forum was held in alternate years in each region on a rotating basis.

The location and agenda for Regional Forums are decided jointly by the Regional Trustee, Area Delegates and GSO. The Area Contact, with the help of the Regional Trustee, is responsible for providing up to three hotel or venue options to be presented to the Meeting, Events and Travel Services (METS) Department. GSO will then select the appropriate venue based on hotel specifications, and the logistical needs of the Forum.

The GSO posts the registration forms and working with the Volunteer Committee Contact and Regional Trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum.

There is no registration fee for Regional Forums. The General Service Board covers the expenses of meeting rooms. In many places, area committees, districts and groups cover or defray the transportation and lodging expenses of the trusted servants representing them at a Forum.

As all Forums are intended to be sharing sessions, no formal actions result. Sharing at Forums is captured in Forum Final Reports which are distributed to all attendees. Regional Forums Final Reports are available on GSO's A.A. Web site. Forums provide unique opportunities to share and exchange valuable experiences, ask questions and spark new ideas. Regional Forums carry A.A.'s message of love and service by improving communication at all levels of our Fellowship.

Please go to <https://www.aa.org/regional-and-local-forums> for information on Local and Special Forums.

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